Clear Sample Data Guide

Remove the sample portfolio, keep every formula, and start fresh safely. Read this BEFORE entering your own TFSA transactions.

THE GOLDEN RULE

NEVER delete rows from the TFSA Portfolio, the Main Dashboard, the Dividend Tracker or Analysis & Reco. The only tab you clear is the Transaction Log.

ALWAYS press the Delete key on the selected cells. It clears the values and keeps every formula intact; every other tab resets to $0.00 on its own.

8 STEPS TO CLEAR THE SAMPLE DATA

1. **Make your copy first**
   Click your template link, click “Make a copy,” and rename it “TFSA Tracker 2026 — [Your Name].” Always work from YOUR copy in Google Drive.

2. **Open the Transaction Log**
   Click the Transaction Log tab at the bottom of the screen.

3. **Find row 4**
   Row 1 is the title and row 3 holds the column headers. Row 4 is the first sample transaction.

4. **Select all sample rows**
   Click cell A4, then press Ctrl+Shift+End (Windows) or Cmd+Shift+End (Mac). This selects everything from A4 to the last sample row.

5. **Press the Delete key only**
   Press Delete. Not Backspace, and not right-click → Delete rows. The values clear and every formula stays in place.

6. **Check the reset**
   Open the Main Dashboard: every value should show $0.00, and the TFSA Portfolio should be empty.

7. **Update Settings & Goals**
   Fill in the amber cells: your name, the Active Year, the TFSA annual limit, your accumulated room and your goals.

8 **Enter your first transaction**
Go back to the Transaction Log and start at row 4. Every tab updates instantly.

TAB-BY-TAB REFERENCE

Tab	Has sample data?	What to do
Transaction Log	YES: rows 4 and below	Press Delete on rows 4+ only. Never delete the rows themselves.
Main Dashboard	No, formulas only	Do nothing. It resets when the Transaction Log is cleared.
TFSA Portfolio	No, formulas only	Do nothing. It fills in from the Transaction Log.
Dividend Tracker	No, formulas only	Do nothing. It calculates on its own.
Analysis & Reco	No, formulas only	Do nothing. It calculates on its own.
Settings & Goals	YES: sample values	Replace the amber cells with your own name, limits and goals.
Start Here	No, instructions	Read once. No changes needed.
ChartData	No, formulas only	Never touch. Hidden helper for the charts.

VERSION HISTORY: YOUR SAFETY NET

Google Sheets saves every change. If something goes wrong: File → Version history → See version history. Find the version from just before the mistake and click “Restore this version.”

> Pro tip: before clearing, name the current version. File → Version history → Name current version → “Before clearing sample data.”